AGROTHYMON

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Extracted Text

AGROTHYMON, from _works_, _stresses_ and _hetype._ A few of wart deferled by Celtics au hard, rough, with a narrow bala and broad top; the top is of the colon: d thyres, it early lipits and bleeds. This tumour is all called tissue.

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Acroteleutic Act.

ACROTELEUTIC, among eccleſiaſtic writers, an appellation given to any thing added to the end of a pſalm; as the Gloria Patri, or Doxology.

ACROTERIA, in architecture, ſmall pedeſtals, uſually without baſes, anciently placed at the middle or two extremes of pediments or frontiſpieces, ſerving to ſupport the ſtatues, &c. It alſo ſignifies the figures placed as ornaments on the tops of churches, and the ſharp pinnacles that ſtand in ranges about flat buildings with rails and balluſters.

Among ancient phyſicians, it ſignified the larger extremities of the body, as the head, hands, and feet. It has alſo been uſed for the tips of the fingers, and ſometimes for the eminences or proceſſes of bones

ACROTHYMION, from ακρον, *extreme*, and θυμος, *thyme*. A ſort of wart deſcribed by Celſus as hard, rough, with a narrow baſis and broad top; the top is of the colour of thyme, it eaſily ſplits and bleeds. This tumour is alſo called *thymus*.

ACT, in general, denotes the exertion of power; and differs from power, as the effect from the cauſe.

Act, in logic, is particularly underſtood of an operation of the human mind. Thus to diſcern and examine, are acts of the underſtanding; to judge and affirm, are acts of the will. There are voluntary and ſpontaneous acts; the former are produced by the operation of the ſoul, the latter without its privity or participation.

Act, in the univerſities, ſignifies a theſis maintained in public by a candidate for a degree; or to ſhow the capacity and proficiency of a ſtudent. The candidates for a degree of bachelor and maſter of arts are to hold philoſophical Acts; and thoſe for bachelor of divinity, theological Acts, &c. At Oxford, the time when maſters or doctors complete their degrees is alſo called the *act*; which is held with great ſolemnity. At Cambridge, they call it the *commencement*.

Act of Faith, *Auto da Fe*, in the Romiſh church is a ſolemn day held by the inquiſition, for the puniſhment of heretics, and the abſolution of the innocent accuſed*. They uſually contrive the *Auto* to fall on ſome great feſtival, that the execution may paſs with the more awe and regard; at leaſt it is always on a Sunday.

*See Inquiſition.

The Auto da Fe may be called the laſt act of the inquiſitorial tragedy; it is a kind of goal-delivery, appointed as oft as a competent number of priſoners in the inquiſition are convicted of hereſy, either by their own voluntary, or extorted confeſſion, or on the evidence of certain witneſſes. The proceſs is thus: in the morning they are brought into a great hall, where they have certain habits put on, which they are to wear in the proceſſion. The proceſſion is led up by dominican friars; after which come the penitents, ſome with ſan-benitoes, and ſome without, according to the nature of their crimes; being all in black coats without ſleeves, and bare-footed, with a wax candle in their hands. Theſe are followed by the penitents who have narrowly eſcaped being burnt, who over their black coats have flames painted with their points turned downwards, *Fuego revolto*. Next come the negative, and relapſed, who are to be burnt, having flames on their habits pointing upwards. After theſe come ſuch as profeſs doctrines contrary to the faith of Rome, who, beſides flames pointing upwards, have their picture painted on their breaſts, with dogs, ſerpents, and devils, all open-mouthed, about it. Each priſoner is attended with a familiar of the inquiſition; and thoſe to be burnt have alſo a Jeſuit on each hand, who are continually preaching to them to abjure. After the priſoners, comes a troop of familiars on horſeback; and after them the inquiſitors, and other officers of the court, on mules; laſt of all, the inquiſitor-general on a white horſe, led by two men with black hats and green hat-bands. A ſcaffold is erected in the *Terriero de Paio*, big enough for two or three thouſand people; at one end of which are the priſoners, at the other the inquiſitors. After a ſermon made up of encomiums of the inquiſition, and invectives againſt heretics, a prieſt aſcends a deſk near the middle of the ſcaffold, and having taken the abjuration of the penitents, recites the final ſentence of thoſe who are to be put to death; and delivers them to the ſecular arm, earneſtly beſeeching at the ſame time the ſecular power not to touch their blood, or put their lives in danger. The priſoners being thus in the hands of the civil magiſtrate, are preſently loaded with chains, and carried firſt to the ſecular goal, and from thence in an hour or two brought before the civil judge; who, after aſking in what religion they intend to die, pronounces ſentence, on ſuch as declare they die in the communion of the church of Rome, that they ſhall be firſt ſtrangled, and then burnt to aſhes; on ſuch as die in any other faith, that they be burnt alive. Both are immediately carried to the Ribera, the place of execution; where there are as many ſtakes ſet up as there are priſoners to be burnt, with a quantity of dry furze about them. The ſtakes of the profeſſed, that is, ſuch as perſiſt in their hereſy, are about four yards high, having a ſmall board towards the top for the priſoner to be ſeated on. The negative and relapſed being firſt ſtrangled and burnt, the profeſſed mount their ſtakes by a ladder; and the Jeſuits, after ſeveral repeated exhortations to be reconciled to the church, part with them, telling them they leave them to the devil, who is ſtanding at their elbow to receive their ſouls, and carry them with him into the flames of hell. On this a great ſhout is raiſed; and the cry is, Let the dogs *beards be made*; which is done by thruſting flaming furzes faſtened to long poles againſt their faces, till their faces are burnt to a coal, which is accompanied with the loudeſt acclamations of joy. At laſt, fire is ſet to the furze at the bottom of the ſtake, over which the profeſſed are chained ſo high, that the top of the flame ſeldom reaches higher than the ſeat they ſit on; ſo that they rather ſeem roaſted than burnt. There cannot be a more lamentable ſpectacle; the ſufferers continually cry out, while they are able, *Miſericordia per amor de Dios*, "Pity for the love of God!" yet it is beheld by all ſexes, and ages, with tranſports of joy and ſatisfaction.

Act.

Act, in dramatic poetry, ſignifies a certain diviſion, or part, of a play, deſigned to give ſome reſpite both to the actors and ſpectators. The Romans were the firſt who divided their theatrical pieces into acts; for no ſuch diviſions appear in the works of the firſt dramatic poets. Their pieces indeed conſiſted of ſeveral parts or diviſions, which they called *protaſis*, *epitaſis*, *cataſtaſis*, and *cataſtrophe*; but theſe diviſions were not marked by any real interruptions on the theatre. Nor does Ariſtotle mention any thing of acts in his Art of Poetry. But, in the time of Horace, all regular and finiſhed pieces were divided into five acts.

Figure 1: *
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